



Differences between the quotation and the schedule received

What matches, what changes day or time, what is missing and what has to be resolved before booking. A line-by-line comparison between quotation COT-2026-0160 and the schedule sent to us.

Ref. COT-2026-0160

Programme 22 - 26 Dec 2026

Travellers 4

WHAT HAS TO BE RESOLVED FIRST

Six points, ordered by what breaks the trip if left alone. The first three are blocking: as it stands today, the schedule cannot be operated.

1 24 and 25 December are Christmas Eve and Christmas Day

Two of the four activity days fall on public holidays: **Thursday 24** with the quad bikes and **Friday 25** with the full-day altiplano trip, which is also the most expensive service in the programme and the hardest to put together.

Operations in San Pedro shrink on those two days. Some operators simply do not run on the 25th, the guides and drivers who do work carry a holiday supplement, and CONAF-administered sites may keep special hours. None of this is impossible, but it is the first thing to confirm and the last thing to leave until the end.

What we do: Ask for availability on the 24th and 25th before anything else, with the holiday supplement in writing. If the 25th is not viable, the full day moves to Wednesday 23 and the rest of the programme reorders around it.

2 The morning of the 22nd does not exist: the flight lands at 18:15

The schedule has an **acclimatization block from 09:00 to 13:00 on Tuesday 22** and, on the same day, the transfer from Calama arriving in San Pedro **at 19:35**. You cannot have a calm morning in San Pedro nine hours before arriving there.

It is also the only line in the schedule that does not say *To be booked*, so it is most likely a placeholder rather than a requested service.

What we do: Confirm whether the acclimatization belongs on **Wednesday 23 in the morning**. If it does, a decision is needed on the Pukará de Quito, which is also on the 23rd and has no time.

3 Rainbow Valley does not fit into the Piedras Rojas day

Friday 25 puts **Chaxa, Toconao, Miscanti, Piedras Rojas and Rainbow Valley** into a single outing from 08:00 to 18:00.

The first four lie **south-east** of San Pedro, climbing the eastern rim of the salt flat to over 4,000 metres. Rainbow Valley lies **north-west**, on the road to Río Grande, in the opposite direction. Putting them in one day adds several hundred kilometres of driving and reduces everything else to drive-past stops.

What we do: Take Rainbow Valley out of the 25th and give it its own half day. **Thursday 24 in the morning** is the natural gap, before the 13:30 quad bikes — subject to operators running on Christmas Eve.

4 The departure transfer is missing

The schedule has the arrival transfer on the 22nd but **not the return** to El Loa airport. The quotation does include it, on Saturday 26, at CLP 30,000 per person.

What we do: Send the outbound flight so the time can be set. And if the trip ends before the 26th, say so: it changes the last day of the programme.

5 Wednesday 23 has two activities and only one has a time

The 23rd carries the **Valle de la Luna at sunset, 17:30 to 20:45**, and the **Pukará de Quito with no time**. In the quotation, Quito sat on Saturday 26 from 08:00 to 10:00.

If the 09:00–13:00 acclimatization also moves there, the day ends up with three blocks and Quito has nowhere to go.

What we do: Decide the order of the 23rd. Quito early with the acclimatization after it works; all three blocks together does not.

6 Quito: you can go on your own, but it is not worth it

This is the question the schedule raises. You can visit the Pukará on your own by paying the community entrance: it is an open site with marked paths.

That said, without a guide it is a hillside with stone walls. What makes the visit worth it is the two hours of interpretation: what each enclosure was, how it fell, and why it is remembered as the last Atacameño stand. The quotation carries it guided, at CLP 75,000 per person plus CLP 6,000 entrance.

What we do: We recommend the guided version. If you prefer self-guided, the CLP 75,000 service comes off and only the entrance fee remains.

DAY BY DAY: QUOTED AGAINST RECEIVED

Eleven lines. On the left the quoted programme, on the right the schedule that arrived.

QUOTED PROGRAMME	SCHEDULE RECEIVED	STATUS
TUESDAY 22 DECEMBER		
Arrival transfer · El Loa → San Pedro Time to be confirmed	Transfer Calama → San Pedro de Atacama 18:15 - 19:35	UNCHANGED
Same service. The schedule pins down the time the quotation had left open.		
—	Acclimatization · calm morning in San Pedro 09:00 - 13:00	NEEDS RESOLVING
Clashes with the 19:35 arrival on the same day — see point 2. On this line the schedule notes “Check Baltinache”, which is not the same thing as Cejar.		
Astronomy tour · shared Wed 23 · 21:00 - 23:00	Private astronomy 22:15 - 23:59	CHANGES
Changes day, time and format. What is quoted is the shared tour at CLP 40,000 per person, coordinated as a courtesy. Private is a different product and has to be quoted.		
WEDNESDAY 23 DECEMBER		
Puritama Hot Springs 09:30 - 13:30	—	NOT IN SCHEDULE
Not in the schedule. It is CLP 75,000 plus CLP 35,000 in park fees per person.		
Valle de la Luna South 16:30 - 20:30	Valle de la Luna at sunset 17:30 - 20:45	CHANGES
An hour later and fifteen minutes longer. Worth confirming it is the same off-circuit route through El Vallecito and not the standard circuit, which is a different product and far busier.		
Quoted for Saturday 26 08:00 - 10:00	Pukará de Quito No time given	CHANGES
Moves forward from Saturday 26 to Wednesday 23 and has no time. The schedule also asks whether it is self-guided: the answer is in point 6.		
THURSDAY 24 DECEMBER		
Valle de Marte + Sandboarding 09:30 - 13:30	Death Valley · quad bikes 13:30 - 15:30	CHANGES
It is the same valley — “Valle de la Muerte” comes from a mistranscription of Valle de Marte — but a different product and a different operator. Two hours instead of four, and in the hottest part of a December day. Not quoted.		
Cejar Lagoon + Ojos de Tebenquiche + Tebenquiche Lagoon 15:30 - 19:30	—	NOT IN SCHEDULE
Not in the schedule. It is CLP 80,000 plus CLP 21,000 in park fees per person. If the idea is to swap it for Baltinache, that is a separate quote: different access, different capacity, and without the floating at Cejar.		

QUOTED PROGRAMME	SCHEDULE RECEIVED	STATUS
FRIDAY 25 DECEMBER		
Piedras Rojas + Tuyajto + Altiplanic Lagoons + Proto-villages + Andean towns 10:00 - 18:00	Altiplano · Chaxa, Toconao, Miscanti, Piedras Rojas & Rainbow Valley 08:00 - 18:00	NEEDS RESOLVING
Two hours longer and a different scope: Chaxa comes in, with its own entrance fee, and Rainbow Valley; Tuyajto and the proto-villages drop out. Rainbow Valley does not combine with Piedras Rojas — see point 3.		
SATURDAY 26 DECEMBER		
Archaeological tour · Pukará de Quito 08:00 - 10:00	Moved to Wednesday 23 —	CHANGES
The service itself is unchanged; only the day moves.		
Departure transfer · San Pedro → El Loa Time to be confirmed	—	NEEDS RESOLVING
Not in the schedule, and the outbound flight is needed to set it. See point 4.		

WHAT HAPPENS TO THE QUOTED PRICE

HOLDS CLP 111,000 2 of 9 services · 13.7%	NEEDS REQUOTING CLP 457,500 4 of 9 services · 56.5%	OUT OF THE SCHEDULE CLP 241,000 3 of 9 services · 29.8%
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Of the **CLP 809,500 per person** in the quotation, only the arrival transfer and the archaeological tour carry over unchanged today. Everything else changes scope, changes format, or drops out.

On top of that, two things move the price on their own and have nothing to do with the schedule: the party went from 2 to **4 travellers** — both trekking alternatives were quoted as a minimum rate for 2 and have to be requested again — and the trip runs **22 to 26 December**, high season with two public holidays inside it. In practice the quotation has to be rebuilt almost entirely.

The schedule also carries five things that are not quoted

- The **acclimatization** on day one, if it is a guided service and not free time.
- The **private astronomy** tour, instead of the shared one that is quoted.
- The **quad bikes** in the Valle de la Muerte.
- **Laguna Chaxa**, added to the altiplano day, with its own entrance fee.
- **Rainbow Valley**, which needs a half day of its own.

WHAT I NEED CONFIRMED

- 1

Is the acclimatization on the 22nd actually meant to be the 23rd?

And is it a guided service or simply free time in San Pedro? If it is guided, it needs quoting.
- 2

What is the outbound flight?

Without it the transfer to El Loa cannot be scheduled and the last day cannot be closed.

3 Does Rainbow Valley come out, or does it get its own half day?

If it stays, Thursday 24 in the morning is the natural gap.

4 Baltinache instead of Cejar, or neither?

The schedule leaves it flagged for review, and they are different products.

5 Is Puritama out of the trip?

It was in the quoted programme and does not appear in the schedule.

6 Quito guided or self-guided, and at what time?

Our recommendation is in point 6.

7 Do the quad bikes replace the sandboarding?

We do not operate them: we need to find who does and quote it separately.

8 Is the private astronomy confirmed?

It changes the price against the shared tour that is quoted, and it changes night.

9 Availability and holiday supplement for 24 and 25 December.

This is the first thing to close: it governs the two most expensive days of the programme.

10 Which vehicle takes the full day with 4 travellers.

With 4 travellers plus a guide-driver the Tahoe is comfortable with luggage; the 4Runner is at its limit on a ten-hour run up to the altiplano. Better settled now.

With those answers I will rebuild the programme and send the corrected quotation for 4 travellers on December dates.